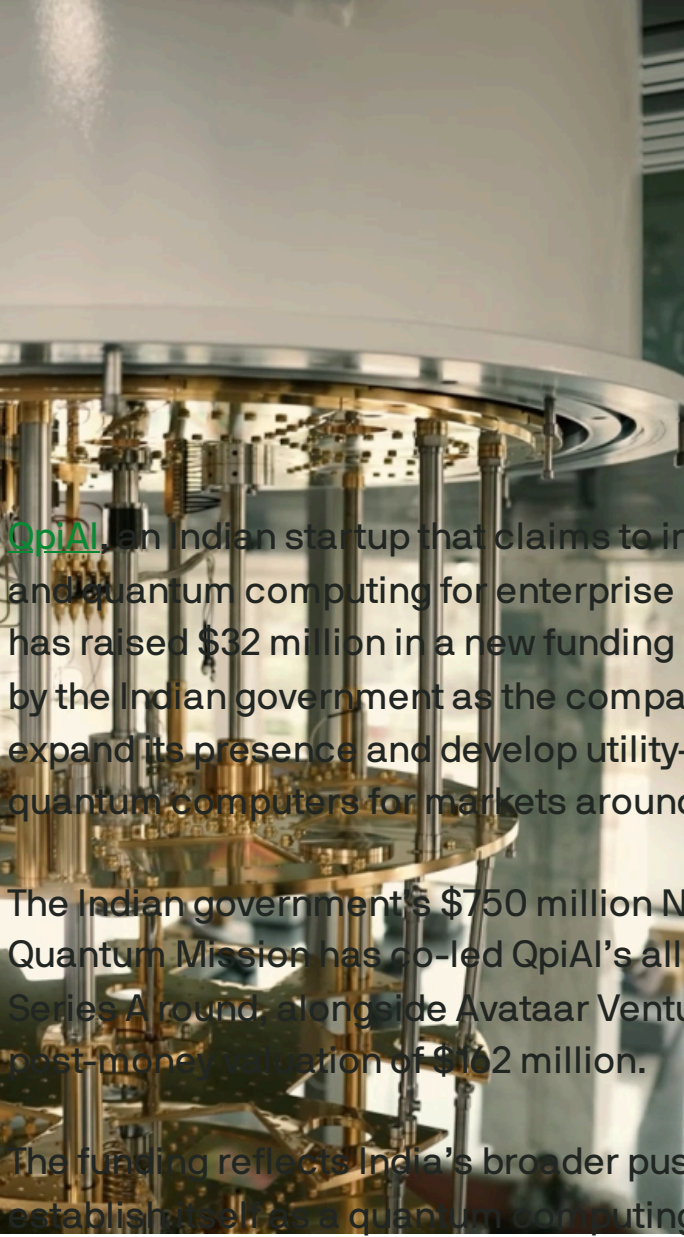


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AI



India eyes global
quantum computer push
— and QpiAI is its chosen
vehicle



[QpiAI](#), an Indian startup that claims to integrate AI and quantum computing for enterprise use cases, has raised \$32 million in a new funding round co-led by the Indian government as the company aims to expand its presence and develop utility-scale quantum computers for markets around the world.

The Indian government's \$750 million National Quantum Mission has co-led QpiAI's all-equity Series A round, alongside Avataar Ventures, at a post-money valuation of \$162 million.

The funding reflects India's broader push to establish itself as a quantum computing power.

Launched in 2023, the [National Quantum Mission](#) is an Indian government initiative that views quantum computing as both an economic opportunity and a national security imperative. The program aims to help develop intermediate-scale quantum computers with 50-1,000 physical qubits within eight years across platforms including superconducting and photonics. It also targets the development of satellite-based quantum communications, inter-city quantum distribution, multi-node quantum networks, magnetometers, and the design and synthesis of quantum materials, including superconductors, semiconductor structures, and topological materials for quantum device fabrication.

QpiAI is [one of eight startups](#) selected by the National Quantum Mission, each receiving an initial grant of up to \$3.5 million. Among these companies,

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the Bengaluru-headquartered startup, which has subsidiaries in the U.S. and Finland, says it has built India's first full-stack quantum computer, called [QpiAI-Indus](#), which it launched in April with 25 superconducting qubits.

Founded in 2019, QpiAI says it integrates quantum computing and AI to provide optimization capabilities in areas such as manufacturing, industrial, transportation, finance, pharma, and materials. The startup says it has developed specialized software, along with its proprietary hardware, to support real-world quantum applications in fields such as materials science and drug discovery.

"Quantum can really make sure AI is robust," said QpiAI founder and CEO Nagendra Nagaraja in an interview.

The startup views simulation, drug synthesis, and material discovery as some of the key use cases where the combination of AI and quantum could provide a competitive edge.

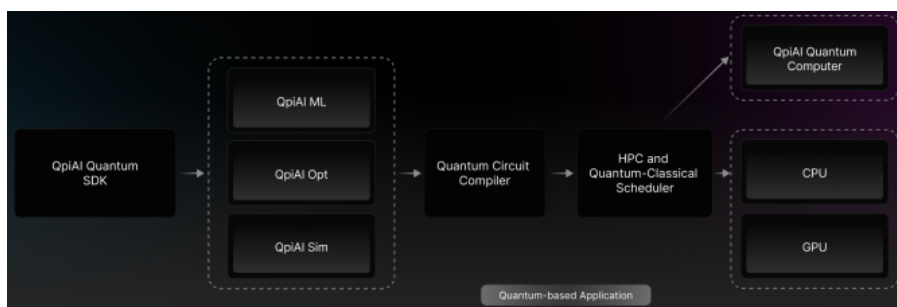
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QPIAI'S FULL-STACK SYSTEM AIMS AT INDUSTRIES SUCH AS LIFE SCIENCES, AUTOMOTIVE, AND FINANCE

IMAGE CREDITS:QPIAI

“Because the design space of a quantum chip is very, very big, and to actually get optimal qubits, which is important when we integrate thousands of qubits to get logical qubits for error correction, AI plays a bigger role there,” Nagaraja told TechCrunch.

QpiAI plans to launch its 64-qubit quantum computer in November, with availability to customers expected by the second or third quarter of next year, Nagaraja said.

The company is also working to start manufacturing its quantum hardware locally in 2026. Currently, it assembles 80% of its machines in-house.

QpiAI employs a 100-person team, comprising 25 PhDs from international institutions or from Indian institutes. About 50 of its employees are based in India. The company says it has around 20 customers in India and the U.S., including the Indian government, which uses its infrastructure to test algorithms.

According to the company, QpiAI has been profitable at EBITDA level for the past three years, with approximately 60% gross margins and 20% to 30% net margins, Nagaraja told TechCrunch.

With the fresh funding, QpiAI plans to enter new markets including Singapore and the Middle East. It also aims to allocate funds for its local manufacturing plans and scale its operations to develop a 100-logical qubit system by 2030.

In June of last year, QpiAI raised \$6.5 million in a pre-Series A round led by YourNest and SVCL at a post-money valuation of around \$30 million.

Nagaraja told TechCrunch that QpiAI has a three- to four-year runway, even without accounting for its profitability. He also said the startup is considering an initial public offering in either 2026 or 2027.

The National Quantum Mission's support extends beyond QpiAI. The Indian government's program is also backing startups such as QNu Labs (working on quantum-safe networks), Dimira Technologies (cryogenic cables), PrenishQ (diode-laser systems), and QuPrayog (optical atomic clocks). It has also supported Quanastra (cryogenic systems and superconducting detectors), Pristine Diamonds (diamond-based sensing materials), and Quan2D Technologies (single-photon detectors for quantum communication).

"We plan to continue to support home-grown product companies like QpiAI to help them expand into large enterprises and position India as global leaders in quantum technologies," said Ajai Chowdhry, chairman of India's National Quantum Mission, in a prepared statement.

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Alice&Bob, a quantum computing startup, raises \$30M to launch its first fault-tolerant ‘cat qubit’ computers in 2023

Ingrid Lunden — 10:35 PM PST · March 9, 2022

IMAGE CREDITS: [JACKIE NIAM](#) / GETTY IMAGES

Quantum computing has been something of a holy grail in the world of technology: In theory, it

promises an unprecedented amount of processing power that could be used to solve the most complicated problems; in practice, most attempts at building the physical manifestation of the concept produce too many errors as a byproduct to make quantum computers productive at scale.

Now a startup out of France believes it has made a breakthrough to solve those issues, and it is announcing some funding to help it apply those advances to building machines it intends to launch next year.

[Alice&Bob](#) — Paris startup that is building what it says are fault-tolerant quantum processors — has raised €27 million (just under \$30 million at today's rates), money that it will use to develop chips and computers and a business model based around exponentially powered quantum-computing-as-a-service, all for a 2023 launch. The Series A is being co-led by Elaia, Bpifrance (by way of its Digital

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me that Alice&Bob devised a different architecture that it calls a “cat qubit,” a reference to [Schrödinger's cat](#) and the idea of something being in “two states” at once, as a way to reduce the faults in processing, thereby to reduce the number of processors needed to overcome those faults.

While most approaches to building quantum computer processors have been based around superconducting circuits — Peronnin notes that this is what IBM and Google have been working on — what his startup has devised “is another kind of chip architecture” that automatically corrects the errors.

Founded by Peronnin and Raphaël Lescanne as a spinout from French academia — of the 40 people who work there now, more than half have Ph.D.s — Alice&Bob has continued to collaborate with French research labs to prove out its approach.

Recent work with one group led by quantum physics professor Zaki Leghtas showed that its cat qubits resist “bit flips” (the name for one of the two types of faults quantum systems usually encounter) for several minutes. That may not sound like much uptime, but it’s nearly a 100,000x improvement on earlier quantum efforts.



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Peronnin tells me that the startup’s next step — and the reason why it will be another year before we see

any product announcements — is to work on using its cat qubit to reduce phase flips (the other type of fault).

The work it has done so far has been extensive enough that Peronnin believes the startup has leaped ahead of many of the quantum efforts of other, much larger tech companies. Alice&Bob has filed patents on its hardware and software components, and while it does not have plans to license it to other companies before using it to build its own computers, he noted that this remains an option down the road.

“At the moment, we’re focusing on building the whole machine because we first have to demonstrate that the technology can deliver on its promises,” he said. “But since we’re seeing some competitors, and part of our technology is patented, then the question [of licensing] will be open.” He noted as one example Amazon’s quantum road map, which mentioned the component that Alice&Bob designed 151 times on 118 pages. “I think we can say they are following us.”

The global quantum race has been precisely that up to now: Although we’ve seen many announcements from larger tech companies of the work that they are doing, plus a wide swath of startups coming out of academia also looking to commercialize their particular advancements and approaches (Alice&Bob being among the latter), no one has actually reached the finish line just yet with machines that can actually deliver, at scale, the kind of exponential computing that quantum computing promises.

Yet it all looks tantalizingly close, and given how the rest of the tech world has advanced — leaps in AI-based concepts and growing ambitions around where they can be applied, a push for using technology to solve some of the world’s most

pernicious problems in areas like health and more, and simply to make existing work more efficient — there remains a huge appetite to continue funding startups like this one to see if someone, or something, can make it all come together in the end.

“As deep tech investors, we are convinced that some of society’s biggest challenges can be addressed by using breakthrough technologies created in research labs,” Sofia Dahoune, investment director at Elaia, said in a statement. “As such, we regard quantum computing as one of the most promising world-changing technologies that could foster extraordinary progress across a broad range of applications.”

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Ingrid was a writer and editor for TechCrunch, from February 2012 through May 2025, based out of London....

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IMAGE CREDITS: QPHOX TEAM



Dutch startup QphoX raises €2M to connect quantum computers with a quantum modem

Mike Butcher — 2:00 AM PDT · May 12, 2021

When eventually they become a working reality, quantum computers won't be of much value if they simply sit there on their own. Just like the internet, the value is in the network. But right now there's scant technology to link these powerful devices.

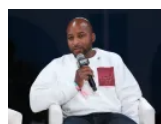
That's where [QphoX](#) comes in. This Dutch startup has raised €2 million to connect quantum computers with a “quantum modem”.

The funding round was led by Quantonation, Speedinvest and High-Tech Gründerfonds, with participation from TU Delft.

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QphoX aims to develop into a commercial product the quantum modem it created at Delft University of Technology (TU Delft). This networks separate processors together, allowing quantum computers to scale beyond tens or hundreds of qubits. Look out for the Singularity folks...

Simon Gröblacher, CEO and co-founder of QphoX, told me: “It is the exact same thing as a classical modem except for quantum computers, so it kind of converts electrical and microwave signals to optical signals coherently, so you don’t do any of the quantum information in the process. It then converts it back so you can really have two quantum computers talk to one another.

[Eight trends accelerating the age of commercial-ready quantum computing](#)



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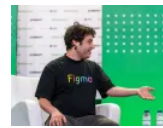
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I noted that there’s more than one type of quantum computer. He countered, “We are in principle agnostic to what kind of quantum computer it is. All we do at the moment is we focus on the microwave

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part, so we can work with superconducting qubits, topological qubits etc. We can convert microwaves to optical signals and they can talk to each other. Currently, the only competitors I know are all the in the academic world. So this is we're the first company to actually starts building a real product."

Rick Hao, principal with Speedinvest's Deep Tech team, added: "We want to invest in seed-stage deep technology startups that shape the future and QphoX is well-positioned to make a major impact. Over the next couple of years, there will be rapid progress in quantum computers. Quantum Modem, the product developed by QphoX, enables the development of quantum computers that demonstrate quantum advantage by combining separate quantum processors."

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